

Ninety days to fifteen projects

How the Key Result gets met, in what order, and what it costs. Sized against the code that exists today rather than against a wish — where something is genuinely unknown, it says so.

KEY RESULT	HARD DEPENDENCY	FIRST BUILD
100% of funded projects fully operational end-to-end	Switchr — not mine to unblock	Instrumentation, week 1
HONEST READ Achievable, minus one thing I don't control		

The one sentence version

Eight of the ten steps in the project workflow already work. Two do not, and both are payment. Philip has confirmed that money moving through Groundwork is inside the definition of “fully operational”, which means **Switchr is the critical path and I cannot start it alone.**

Everything else on this plan is buildable now, mostly small, and sequenced so that none of it waits on Switchr. If the introduction lands in week 2, the Key Result is reachable. If it lands in week 6, it is not — and we should re-cut the quarter in week 2 rather than discover that in week 8.

The single decision that governs this plan. Every other risk here has a workaround. This one does not: no amount of process substitutes for a payment rail, because a payment recorded by hand is a record that money moved somewhere else.

01 Making the Key Result scoreable

Today I cannot score it, and that is the first thing to fix. Nothing in the product records whether a project completed the whole chain — the data exists in pieces, in different tables, with no view that joins them into a yes or a no.

Proposed definition, written so a query can answer it. A project counts as fully operational when every line below is true of it. Not “broadly working” — each is a column I can select on:

- ☐ **Set up completely.** Budget confirmed and the ten stages created. A project with an estimate but no stage schedule is not started.
- ☐ **Team assigned.** At least one contractor invited and accepted, so the project has somebody other than the client on it.
- ☐ **Reached a milestone.** At least one stage past active — the workflow has actually been exercised, not just configured.
- ☐ **Evidence attached.** Every completed substage on a charged stage carries at least one file. This is the line that makes the record defensible.
- ☐ **Verified by Jalla.** At least one stage approved through the review queue, with a certificate issued. **Zero certificates exist today**, so this line is currently false for every project on the platform.
- ☐ **Payment released through Groundwork.** Not a flag someone typed — a transaction the platform performed. False for every project until Switchr ships.
- ☐ **No manual intervention.** No admin edited a record by hand to move it forward. Requires a log of interventions, which does not exist yet either.

Week-1 build: the readiness view. One query per project answering those seven lines, surfaced on an internal screen. It scores the Key Result, it becomes the Project Health signal I proposed, and it is what tells me a project has gone quiet — three uses, one build. Nothing else on this plan can be measured until it exists, which is why it goes first rather than last.

02 The critical path

In dependency order. The tags say who has to move before I can, which is the part worth reading — five of the seven are mine alone, and the two that are not are the two that can stop the quarter.

1 Readiness instrumentation

The view above, plus an interventions log. Everything downstream is measured against it, and without it I am reporting impressions.

MINE ALONE

WEEK 1

~3 DAYS

2 A project-scoped verifier role

Philip has answered the scope: a verifier sees only the project they are verifying. That makes it buildable now — a role, an assignment per project, and row-level policies on the four tables a verifier touches. It also ends the current position where every verification requires a full administrator.

MINE ALONE

WEEKS 2–3

~1 WEEK

3 Let Jalla advance a managed project

Today only the homeowner can mark a substage complete — a contractor cannot, and nor can we. On fifteen Jalla-managed builds that means either the client does our admin or we sign in as administrators. Neither is “operational”. Same shape as the verifier work, so build them together.

MINE ALONE

WEEKS 2–3

FOLDED IN

4 Switchr: charge, hold, release

The long pole, and not mine to start. Cannot be sized until I have seen their API and their licensed corridors — a rail that cannot legally move money to Cameroon changes the plan rather than the schedule. Assume three weeks of build once access exists, and treat that as a guess.

NEEDS PHILIP · WEEK 2

WEEKS 3–8

UNSIZED

5 Evidence standards enforced by the form

Required shots and captions per milestone type, and a rejection-reason list, so the standard is enforced where evidence is submitted rather than caught afterwards. Fast to build; entirely blocked on what the standard is.

NEEDS VANESSA · WEEK 2

WEEKS 4–5

~1 WEEK

6 Weekly operating surface

The review queue, filtered per verifier, with per-project timers and a digest. Today fifteen projects arrive as one undifferentiated list and nothing chases. This is what makes “on-time weekly verification” measurable rather than aspirational.

MINE ALONE

WEEKS 5–6

~1 WEEK

7 The exportable proof pack

Every project's full record — milestones, evidence, sign-offs, payments — as one downloadable document. The certificate generator already produces PDFs, so this is assembly rather than new machinery. Serves the client, Vanessa's QA and the data room from one build.

MINE ALONE

WEEKS 7–8

~1 WEEK

03 One correction, one clarification

The estimator figure in my sprint document is out of date, and the note about cities needs one detail added. Both are the kind of thing that gets quoted back, so they are fixed here.

ESTIMATOR VARIANCE

I wrote “21% under to 31% over”. That was August. It is now **14.6% under to 52.1% over** — and the picture is better than those numbers suggest. **Naka, the only document that priced a whole building the way we do, is within 1.1%.** Mpangou moved from +31% to +52% because I corrected a real fault: the estimator was charging one suspended floor slab for a building of any height, when a three-storey block needs three. It also prices a half-built continuation, so we expect to sit above it.

WHICH CITY IS THE BASE

Yaoundé and Douala are both our base, and the ask to Vanessa is current rates for both. One clarification worth carrying into that conversation: inside the estimator, Yaoundé is the reference every other city is priced against — Douala currently sits 5% below it. So a correction to the Yaoundé rate moves every city, and a correction to Douala moves only Douala. Of the four bills of quantities we hold, Rose is the Yaoundé one; the like-for-like document is Naka, in Bamenda. **We have no Douala bill of quantities at all**, which is the gap worth closing first.

The estimator is therefore in better shape than the assignment implies, and the remaining work on it is not mine to guess at: it is eighteen questions already written and waiting on Vanessa, three of which decide whether tall buildings are priced correctly at all.

04 What I am cutting, and what I am not

IN

- Everything on the critical path above
- The remaining beta-tester defects — small, and they are why adoption stalled
- The creation flow: new-vs-ongoing build and plan upload
- Payments recorded inside the stage, not on a separate screen
- Cameroon only

OUT THIS QUARTER

- Nigeria — no bill of quantities exists, so every figure would be a guess
- Roofing presentation rework
- The resources and guides library
- Admin ↔ verifier collaboration tooling beyond the role itself
- Second design options — one per screen

BRIDGED, NOT BUILT

- The weekly verification schedule, from a spreadsheet until week 6
- Evidence standards by SOP until the form enforces them
- Payment by hand — **only until Switchr**, and no longer counted as operational

What is *not* cut, deliberately: the beta defect list. It is small work and it is the difference between a platform testers abandoned and one they use — and fifteen projects on an unusable product is not fifteen operational projects.

05 What kills this plan

RISK	TELL	WHAT I DO ABOUT IT
Switchr access slips past week 2	No introduction by the Friday of week 2.	Escalate on that Friday, not in week 8. If it slips to week 6, the KR as written cannot be met and we should re-cut it then — while there is quarter left to spend on something else.
The corridor does not exist	Switchr cannot legally move money into Cameroon.	This changes the company plan, not my schedule. Worth asking in the same conversation as the introduction, because it is the cheaper question to answer.
The verification standard does not arrive	No written evidence standard by week 3.	Ship the form with a provisional standard I draft from the four bills of quantities, marked as provisional, and revise. Better than fifteen projects of inconsistent evidence.
Fifteen projects do not materialise	Fewer than fifteen funded projects reach setup. Lead flow is marketing's to measure, not mine — I see it when projects arrive, or don't.	This is why the measure is <i>funded projects</i> rather than fifteen. Nine clean projects is a product win; the wording should not turn it into a 60% score. Nothing on this plan changes if the number is nine.
I am the only developer	Any week where the Gate Meeting has nothing shipped.	Weekly release is the control, not the ambition — a week with nothing to show is the signal, and it should be treated as one rather than absorbed.

06 What I need, and by when

Unchanged from my sprint assignment except for the estimator ask, which the corrections above re-point. Repeated here because the plan above is built on

these dates and fails without them.

PHILIP · WEEK 2	Introduction to Switchr and test-environment access, plus their licensed corridor list. Blocks the critical path. Everything else on this plan can proceed without it; the Key Result cannot.
VANESSA · WEEK 2	The verification standard — what counts as acceptable evidence, per milestone type. Blocks the evidence build and, until it exists, every project's evidence is inconsistent by default.
VANESSA · WEEK 3	Current rates for Yaoundé and Douala , and a Douala bill of quantities if one exists — we hold none. Plus the three estimator questions that decide whether tall buildings are priced correctly.
COMPANY · WEEK 1	A pre-approved tooling ceiling — error monitoring, analytics, evidence storage. Small amounts, but each one blocks a build until approved.

The boundary I am holding. Vanessa defines the operational standard; I build the mechanism that enforces it. I should not be inventing her operating model, and she should not be specifying how it is implemented. Where a standard has not arrived by its date, I will ship a provisional version rather than wait — and say clearly that it is provisional.

Sized against the Groundwork codebase as it stands on 11 September 2026, and against a read-only probe of the live database. Estimates for work I have seen are given in days or weeks; the Switchr integration is deliberately left unsized, because sizing an integration against an API nobody has seen is a guess wearing a number.